Rony Rodrigo Maximiliano Rodriguez-Ramirez

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HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Education

Harvard University — 2023–2027 (anticipated)
Ph.D. Education Policy & Program Evaluation
Affiliations: Center for International Development (CID), Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS), Education Lab for Latin America (ELLA, co-founder)

KDI School of Public Policy & Management — 2018
M.Sc. Development Policy (Summa Cum Laude)

Universidad Centroamericana, Nicaragua — 2015
B.Sc. Applied Economics (Summa Cum Laude, Best Student Overall Performance)

Fields

Economics of Education, Development Economics; Labor Economics (secondary)

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Harvard University
Prof. Eric Taylor (2024–2025); *Prof. Dan Levy* (2024–2025); *Prof. Emiliana Vegas* (2023–2024); *Dr. Álvaro Hofflinger*, DRCLAS (2023–2024)

Research Consultant, The World Bank
Development Research Group (DECRG), *PIs: Berk Özler, Lelys Dinarte-Díaz, and David McKenzie* (2021–2023); Development Impact Evaluation (DIME), *PIs: John Loeser and Florence Kondylis* (2020–2021)

Research Assistant, Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México–IPA — 2019–2020
Prof. Mauricio Romero

Research Assistant, University of Oxford — 2019–2020
Prof. Nathaniel Lane

Research Assistant, KDI School of Public Policy & Management — 2018–2019
Prof. Hee-Seung Yang

Teaching Experience

Teaching Fellow, Harvard University
Education Policy Analysis (EPA 101), *Prof. Emiliana Vegas* (Fall 2026); Advanced Quantitative Methods (API 209), *Prof. Dan Levy* (Fall 2026); Using Big Data to Solve Economic and Social Problems, *Prof. Raj Chetty and Dr. Greg Bruich* (2026); Economics of Education in Low- and Middle-Income Countries, *Prof. Alejandro Ganimian* (2026); Advanced Quantitative Methods (API 209), Math Camp, *Prof. Dan Levy* (Summer 2024, 2026); Education Policy Analysis (EPA 101), *Profs. Emiliana Vegas, Eric Taylor, and Susan Dynarski* (2024–2025)

Instructor, The World Bank
R for Stata Users; Reproducible Research Fundamentals (2021–2023)

Instructor, Lambda Institute, Perú
Advanced Stata for Economists (2020, 2021); Advanced Methods in Econometrics (2021); Impact Evaluation (2021)

Adjunct Lecturer, Universidad Centroamericana, Nicaragua
Social and Human Economy (2018)

Teaching Assistant, KDI School, Republic of Korea
Foundations of Sustainable Development, *Prof. Booyuel Kim* (2018); Impact Evaluation Methods, *Prof. Booyuel Kim* (2017)

Grants & Awards

Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics 2026
US$18,000; "Mitigating Summer Learning Loss: A Parental Intervention in Pakistan"; Co-PI with Roohullah Gulzari

David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies, Harvard 2026
US$14,000; "Evaluating the Causal Impact of Programa Todos Humanos on Socio-Emotional Learning in Argentine Primary Schools"

Strategic Impact Evaluation Fund (SIEF) 2025
US$400,000; "Supporting Mental Health in Armenia"; Co-PI with Renata Lemos and Lelys Dinarte-Díaz

State and Peacebuilding Program Trust Fund 2024
US$2.8 million; "Supporting Mental Health in Armenia"; Co-PI with Renata Lemos and Lelys Dinarte-Díaz

Stone Research Grant, Harvard Kennedy School 2024
US$5,000; Co-PI with Jostin Kitmang

Strategic Impact Evaluation Fund (SIEF) 2023
US$400,000; "Tech-Enabled Tutoring Program in Ukraine"; Co-PI with Renata Lemos and Lelys Dinarte-Díaz

Presidential Scholar, Harvard University 2023

Outstanding Master's Thesis Award, KDI School 2018

Korean Government Scholarship Program (KGSP) 2015

Best Student Performance Award, Universidad Centroamericana 2015
Highest GPA in the Applied Economics Department

Publications

Journal Articles

"The Rise of Post-Pandemic Bullying and Its Association with Student Achievement and School Attachment: Evidence from Chile" 2026
Rony Rodriguez-Ramirez, Álvaro Hofflinger, and Emiliana Vegas. *International Journal of Educational Development*, 103677

"Does the Small Business Program Benefit Self-Employed Workers? Evidence from Nicaragua" 2024
Booyuel Kim, **Rony Rodriguez-Ramirez**, and Hee-Seung Yang. *Journal of Development Effectiveness*, 1–20

Book Chapters

"School Closures and Out-of-School Children During the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Global Perspective" Forthcoming
Rony Rodriguez-Ramirez and Emiliana Vegas. In Steve Bradley and Colin Green, eds., *Economics of Education*, 3rd ed., Elsevier

"From Closure to Recovery: Tracing the Educational Impact of COVID-19 in Chile" 2024
Emiliana Vegas, **Rony Rodriguez-Ramirez**, and Álvaro Hofflinger. In Harry Patrinos and Nuno Crato, eds., *Improving National Education Systems After COVID-19*, Springer, 17–36

Policy Reports

"Navigating Opportunity: Career Information and Mobility in Low-Wage Employment" 2025
Joseph B. Fuller, Kerry McKittrick, Amanda Holloway, **Rony Rodriguez-Ramirez**, and Ali Epstein. Harvard Kennedy School

Working Papers

"Investing in Human Capital During Wartime: Experimental Evidence from Ukraine"
with Lelys Dinarte-Díaz, James Gresham, Renata Lemos, and Harry Patrinos

"Shifting Governance: Assessing the Impact of Chile's Educational Integration Reforms on School and Student Outcomes"

"Who Learns What? Combining Causal Forests and IRT in an Online Tutoring RCT for Ukrainian Students"

"Shared Decision-Making: Does Quality of Care Affect Contraceptive Use?"
with Berk Özler and Luca Parisotto

"In Utero Exposure to Civil Conflict: Nicaraguan War and Its Long-Term Effects on Socioeconomic Outcomes"
with Booyuel Kim and Hee-Seung Yang

Work in Progress

"Supporting Mental Health Through the Promotion of Psychosocial Support in Armenian Schools"
with Lelys Dinarte-Díaz and Renata Lemos. In the field. AEA RCT Registry

"Can Parents Fill the Gap? Information, Support, and Human Capital When Schools Close"
with Roohullah Gulzari. AEA RCT Registry

"The Role of Selective Public Universities in Shaping Long-Term Outcomes"
with Jostin Kitmang

Seminars, Conferences, & Talks

AI in Higher Education ANZ, University of Sydney; NCME–AERA; CESifo Munich	2026
ACME, Harvard; Doctoral Colloquium, Harvard; Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness	2025
NEUDC, Northeastern University; Economics of Education Seminar, Harvard	2024
Stata Conference, Stanford	2023
The World Bank DIME–KDI School joint conference on Impact Evaluation in Sustainable and Inclusive Development	2021
Allied Social Science Association (ASSA) meetings; Universidad Centroamericana	2019

Academic Service

Mentor, Fair Graduate Admissions Pathway (FGAP), Columbia University; Mentor, Econ Thaki; Admissions Ambassador, Harvard Graduate School of Education

Languages

Spanish (native); English (fluent); French (DELF B2); Korean (TOPIK 4); Nicaraguan Sign Language (intermediate); Latin (beginner); Armenian (beginner)

Software Skills

Data analysis: R, Stata, Python, SQL; Programming: JavaScript, TypeScript

Survey tools: ODK (SurveyCTO, KoboToolbox), Qualtrics; Geospatial: ArcGIS

Personal Information

Citizenship: Nicaraguan